MONTHLY UPDATE

Central Africa: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

PROGRESS

INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES
Regional collaboration

INSTRUMENTS AND HARMONISATION
Standards

SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Data Storage · Digital Payments and Fintech · National statistics

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

REGIONAL FRAMEWORK ON CROSS-BORDER DATA GOVERNANCE

- **Atelier régional d'engagement des parties prenantes pour l'élaboration d'un cadre régional de la CEEAC en matière de gouvernance transfrontalière des données** — 7 jours info, 3 September 2026 CAMEROON

  Douala, 31 August to 4 September: experts pick the pillars of the ECCAS data framework.

- **ECA and partners advance ECCAS regional data governance framework** — United Nations Economic Commission for Africa (ECA), 4 September 2026

  Douala consultations closed 4 Sep 2026: 27 participants, EU and GIZ backing, framework plus roadmap due.

- **Afrique centrale : la CEEAC avance vers un cadre commun de gouvernance des donnees transfrontalieres** — Journal des Nations, 8 September 2026

  Five-day Douala workshop, 31 August to 4 September 2026, drafting a common cross-border data governance framework.

CENTRAL AFRICA INTERNET GOVERNANCE FORUM

- **Les travaux du forum sur la gouvernance de l'Internet en Afrique centrale lancés à N'Djamena - Tchadinfos** — Tchadinfos, 13 October 2026 CHAD

  Chad's digital ministry and its partners opened the Central Africa Internet Governance Forum in N'Djamena on 13 October 2026.

Instruments and harmonisation

Standards

SDMX STANDARD AND OPEN DATA PLATFORM

- **Gabon : ouverture de l'atelier BAD-CEMAC sur la mise en œuvre du SDMX et l'implémentation de l'Open Data Platform** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 14 September 2026

  CEMAC states begin SDMX implementation and Open Data Platform migration at a Libreville workshop.

- **CEMAC: accélération de la modernisation des systèmes statistiques avec l'adoption du SDMX et la migration vers l'ODP 2.0** — 7 jours info, 15 September 2026 GABON

  No CEMAC state has yet migrated to ODP 2.0 or automated SDMX exchange; CEMAC-Data beta due during the workshop.

CEMAC STATISTICAL HARMONISATION ON SDMX AND THE OPEN DATA PLATFORM

- **Gabon/Atelier BAD-CEMAC-UNFPA: 14 recommandations formulées** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse (AGP), 18 September 2026

  14 recommendations close the Libreville workshop; World Bank no-objection and HISWACA disbursement delays named.

- **Statistiques et données : Les pays de l'Afrique Centrale sur la même longueur d'ondes** — Gabonactu.com, 20 September 2026

  A five-day African Development Bank, CEMAC and UNFPA workshop closed at Libreville with a 2026-2029 calendar for migrating the six member states to SDMX and version 2.0 of the Open Data Platform. The stated aim is not to make the national statistical systems uniform but to define common structures that let them interoperate; 14 recommendations were addressed to the institutes, the Commission, the Bank and the World Bank.

Shared systems and infrastructure

Connectivity

COMMON FRAMEWORK FOR NATIONAL EMERGENCY TELECOMMUNICATIONS PLANS

- **Afrique Centrale: Télécoms - La région renforce ses dispositifs face aux catastrophes naturelles** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville (via allAfrica), 15 September 2026 CONGO

  Brazzaville, 15-16 Sept 2026: eight ECCAS states draft a model national emergency telecoms plan.

- **Le Congo et l'Afrique centrale s'organisent pour mieux résister aux catastrophes** — La Brève Online, 15 September 2026 CONGO

  Congo's FASUCE reports 380,000 people and 250 localities newly connected, at the Brazzaville emergency-telecoms workshop.

- **Télécoms : l'Afrique centrale renforce ses dispositifs face aux catastrophes naturelles** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 15 September 2026 CONGO

  A regional workshop in Brazzaville on 15 and 16 September worked towards a common framework for national emergency telecommunications plans across central Africa, convened by the international telecommunications union with the regional regulators' assembly and the economic community.

Data Storage

REGIONAL CENTRAL BANK SOVEREIGN CLOUD

- **CEMAC: Yvon Sana Bangui hace balance de la transformación del sistema bancario y financiero regional** — Oficina de Informacion y Prensa de Guinea Ecuatorial, 4 October 2026

  The governor of the Bank of Central African States, closing the CEMAC Bankers' Days in Bangui on 3 October, set a goal that by the end of 2027 every transfer under CFA 5 million settles in under ten seconds on the region's interoperable instant payment system. He also cited a regional switch project and a central bank sovereign cloud to keep payment data in the region, and a 35% financial inclusion target for 2028.

Digital Payments and Fintech

BEAC ACCESSION TO PAPSS

- **Intégration financière : la BEAC et le PAPSS mobilisent les banques de la CEMAC** — Journal du Cameroun, 9 September 2026 CAMEROON

  BEAC webinar of 9 September 2026 to bring CEMAC commercial banks onto PAPSS after the central bank's own accession.

- **Central Africa: Instant Payments Outpace Central Africa's Anti-Money Laundering Controls** — Institute for Security Studies (Tshwane/Pretoria), via allAfrica.com, 17 September 2026

  A think-tank analysis sets Central Africa's instant-payment rail against the zone's exchange and anti-money-laundering rules: settlement takes seconds where the rules expect documentary checks before a transfer, and fewer than 13 per cent of adults hold an account.

- **Instant payments outpace Central Africa's anti-money laundering controls** — Institute for Security Studies (ISS Africa), 17 September 2026

  An analysis sets the pan-African settlement rail against Central Africa's exchange and anti-money-laundering rules: the rail settles in seconds where the rules expect documentary checks before a transfer, and fewer than 13 per cent of adults in the zone hold an account. The supervisory model and the instrument are not on the same clock.

BEAC CENTRAL BANK DIGITAL CURRENCY

- **La BEAC accélère sa réforme bancaire en Afrique centrale** — Journal Le Pays (Tchad), 15 September 2026

  BEAC governor meets the IMF's Africa director, 14 Sept 2026: a CBDC, COBAC's powers, the refinancing window.

REGIONAL MONEY MARKET AND CENTRAL DEPOSITORY PLATFORM

- **BEAC - Sélection internationale ouverte n°150/BEAC/DGEFRI-CRCT/SIO/Ser/2026 pour l'acquisition et la mise en œuvre d'une plateforme couvrant les activités du marché monétaire de la CEMAC et du Dépositaire Central Unique** — Banque des Etats de l'Afrique Centrale (BEAC), 28 September 2026

  Own-funds tender; XAF 2m entry fee; framing meeting 21 Oct 2026; bids due 19 Nov 2026.

- **Six-Nation CEMAC Bloc Plans New Platform for Bank Liquidity and Securities Transactions** — Ecofin Agency, 2 October 2026

  BEAC tender of 30 Sept 2026 for one platform across money market and central depository; no technical specs disclosed.

CEMAC INTEROPERABLE INSTANT PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **CEMAC: Yvon Sana Bangui hace balance de la transformación del sistema bancario y financiero regional** — Oficina de Informacion y Prensa de Guinea Ecuatorial, 4 October 2026

> Summarised under Data Storage.

> CEMAC PAYMENT INSTITUTIONS' OPERATIONS
>
> - **CEMAC : le mobile money brasse 44 000 milliards FCFA en 2025 et génère 47 milliards de bénéfices aux opérateurs** — Ecomatin, 9 October 2026 CAMEROON CONGO GABON CHAD
>
>   Central Africa's seven licensed payment institutions processed 4.6 billion operations worth FCFA 44,037 billion in 2025, against 3.4 billion operations in 2024, on the banking commission's annual report. Two Cameroonian operators' services held 65.4% of the sector's income.

National statistics

> COMMON CEMAC ENERGY INFORMATION SYSTEM (SIE-CEMAC) AND NATIONAL ENERGY INFORMATION SYSTEMS
>
> - **Énergie : la CEMAC prépare un système d'information commun** — GabonReview, 21 September 2026
>
>   Draft community regulation on energy data collection, validation and dissemination; ministers meet 25 September.
>
> - **Gabon/CEMAC: experts formulate recommendations for the regional energy-information system ahead of the ministerial meeting** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse (AGP), 23 September 2026
>
>   Draft regulation and roadmap validated 23 Sep; experts ask dedicated budgets and permanent staff for national SIE cells.
>
> - **Données énergétiques : la CEMAC veut parler d'une même voix** — GabonReview, 25 September 2026
>
>   CEMAC energy ministers met in Libreville on a draft regulation creating a community energy information system (SIE-CEMAC), setting rules for collecting, processing, keeping and sharing energy data. Gabon's energy minister asked the African Energy Commission for technical and financial support and said the sharing of some energy data must be limited because it falls under national sovereignty.
>
> - **Gabon/CEMAC/Énergie : validation du règlement portant création du SIE** — AGP - Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 25 September 2026
>
>   Ministers validate regulation and roadmap 25 Sep 2026; data pooling added to art. 2; sent to UEAC Council.

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